

Operate your Conf

Perhaps the most important part of the `ircd.conf` file is the operator setting. If you do this right, not only will you be able to connect to your IRC server, but also control it from your IRC client itself.

Before you go ahead with editing the operator block of the conf file, you need to use the `./mkpasswd` utility to create an encrypted password. `cd` to the `/ircd/bin` folder and type `./mkpasswd` at the 'Plain text' prompt. Key in your password and press [Enter]. The encrypted password will be displayed. For example, if you type `./mkpasswd`, enter `digit` and press `[Enter]`, you'll see something like `guVWjn80QWx/g` as the encrypted password. If you try the same thing again, the encrypted password that's outputted will be different.

Here's how the first four lines of your operator block should look:

```
operator {
    name = "<Your Name>";
    user = "*@127.0.0.1";
    password = "quVwjn80OWx/q";
}
```

You also need to remember that if you spoofed your host (127.0.0.1) to something like 'My.Spoofed.Host' in the auth.conf file, the user line should read `'user="*@My.Spoofed.Host"',` for the IRCd to recognise you.

Note: Editing a line in the `ircd.conf` file will let you use plain text passwords instead, but this is not recommended under any circumstances.

 Use **'make'** to compile the daemon.

 This done, use ***'make install'*** to install the program into the correct directory, and with the right arguments that you specified when using ***'./configure'***.

STEP 5 You'll now find that the folder you wanted the IRCd installed in has been created. Enter that folder. Type **'ls'** and you'll see six directories: **bin**, **etc**, **help**, **logs**, **messages** and **modules**. **'cd'** to the **/etc** directory and edit the example.conf file using your text editor. We used Pico, by typing

'pico example.conf'. Each and every setting is explained in this file with a detailed explanation. Read the file carefully, and change the settings as per your requirements. (See box **'Operate your Conf'**, for important administration settings) Finally, save the file as **'ircd.conf'** and quit the editor.

```

/*
 * IMPORTANT NOTES:
 * 1. Both blocks MUST be specified in order of precedence.
 * 2. That matches a user will be used. So place specific
 * 3. then general names, then restrictions.
 * 4. Both shell style ($) and C style comments are supported.
 * 5. Files may be included by either:
 *      .include "filename"
 *      .include <filename>
 * 6. Times/durations are written as:
 *      12 hours 30 minutes 1 second
 * 7. Valid units of time:
 *      month, week, day, hour, minute, second
 * 8. Valid units of size:
 *      megabyte/mbytes/mh, kilobyte/bytes/kb, byte
 * 9. Sizes and times may be singular or plural.
 */
/* serverinfo ||: Contains information about the

```

Once you're done editing the conf file, you're all set to start the IRCd

STEP 6 ‘cd’ to the bin folder, and start the IRCd using the ‘./ircd **ircd.conf**’ command. A message saying something like ‘MusIRCd-2.0rc3 running in background from <path> pid: <number>’ appears.

[illegible]

Starting the IRCd launches it into the background

5 The next thing to do is connect to
6 the IRCd. We used the command
line EPIC IRC client to test our server,
which is available at **www.epicsol.org**. You
can also connect from a Windows
computer using the popular mIRC client
(**www.mirc.com**). Those running Unix-based
platforms (Linux, FreeBSD, etc.) may try out
the XChat GUI IRC client (**www.xchat.org**).

5 If all goes well, you should connect and see the Message of the Day (MOTD). Now, use the **'/oper <user> <pass>'** command to see if you set the Operator settings properly. You can also use the **'/raw help'** command for help. If

Run the **`./configure`** command with the desired switches to personalise the installation



Jargon Buster

IRC Operators: All server administrators are also IRC Operators, but the converse isn't true. Most server administrators can't be online all the time to maintain their servers. So, they appoint certain trusted users to care for the server. These IRC Operators can disconnect and even ban users from a server. They can also link and unlink networked servers from each other.

Spoof: All users on an IRC server are identified by their user@host, or user@IP addresses. As IRC operators are hated by troublemakers, they choose to protect themselves by faking their IPs. This fake IP is called a spoof, and is limited only by imagination—spoofs such as bill@clinton.gov, or you@talk.too.much are common.

you can connect to the IRCd, you've probably set everything just right.

Even if you don't have a static IP, don't fret. See the box 'No IP? No Problem' on the first page for details on how you can change your dynamic DNS into a static URL. Once you've done that, call or IM all your colleagues and get them to get on your IRC server. If it's set to run only on the LAN, tell them to connect to *irc://<your server's IP>:<port*

you specified in `ircd.conf` (such as `irc://127.0.0.1:6667`). Make sure you inform everyone to install an IRC client first.

Daemon's end

We installed and ran both the JabberD and IRCd on a Pentium III 500 MHz, with 64 MB SDRAM (though we started with 128 MB of RAM, someone 'borrowed' a 64 MB stick), a 4 GB hard drive, a keyboard and no mouse. We never even installed X-Windows, since the system was grossly underpowered, but then again, we didn't need to. We ran both daemons simultaneously and faced no problems.

So, all you need to do in order to test both these interesting ways of communication is get your hands on some old hardware, load Linux and the two daemons mentioned here, and inform everyone. Happy chatting! 

SRINIVASAN RAMAKRISHNAN
srinivasan_ramakrishnan@thinkdigit.com
ROBERT SOVEREIGN-SMITH
robert_smith@thinkdigit.com